CONFOEDERATIO,
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DEMOGRAPHIC HISTORY OF GALICIA AND VOLHYNIA (10000BC - 1300AD)

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (10000BC - 1300AD).

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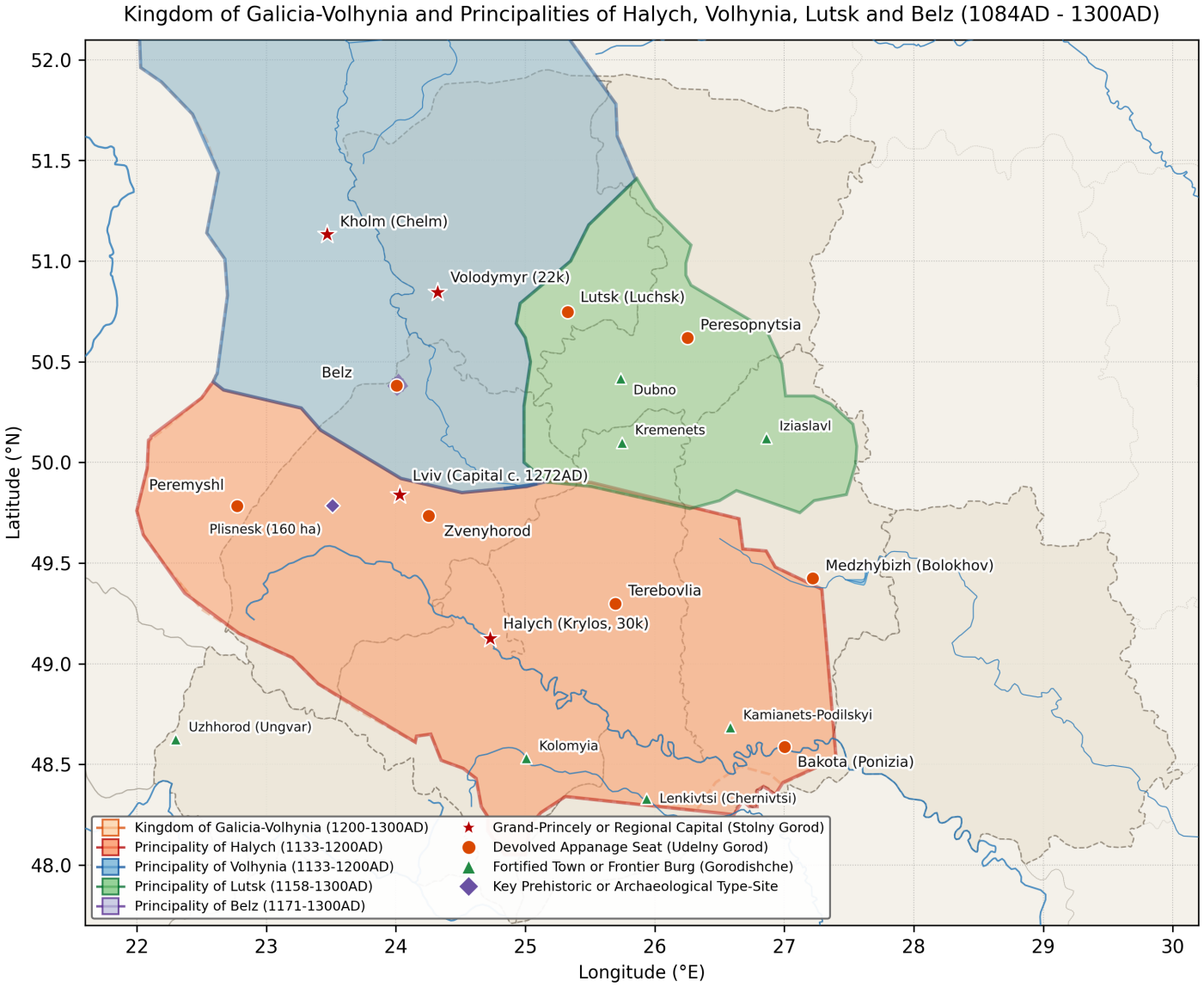


Figure 1. Regional boundaries and fortified settlements of the principalities of Galicia, Volhynia, Lutsk, Belz and Ponizia (10000BC - 1300AD).

Abstract

This review reconstructs the population and settlement history of Galicia and Volhynia in South-Western Rus, from the Upper Palaeolithic (10000BC) to the Mongol campaigns of Batu Khan (1240-1241AD) and the post-conquest Romanovichi Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (Kingdom of Rus, 1250AD - 1300AD) [1][2][3]. Across the Holocene and pre-Mongol medieval period, South-Western Rus experienced four main demographic cycles before Batu Khan's 1240-1241AD campaign: first, the Trypillia-Cucuteni Dniester-Prut-Bug Eneolithic peak (c. 3500BC, 260k) anchored by *Bilche-Zolote (Verteba)*, *Koshylivtsi*, *Bodaki*, *Zalishchyky* and *Stina* [4]; second, the Vysotska and Early Scythian West Podolian hillfort horizon (c. 500BC, 490k) centred on the 110 ha rampart hillfort at *Nemyriv*, *Severynivka* and *Hryhorivka* [5]; third, the Chernyakhov, Lipitsa, Przeworsk and Carpathian Tumuli Culture expansion (c. 300AD, 680k) [6][7]; and fourth, the Galician-Volhynian urban and rural peak (1000AD - 1200AD), when 350 fortified *gorodishcha* (n=350) and sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres supported 1,15M in 1000AD, 1,46M in 1100AD and 1,82M in 1200AD [8][9][10]. Following the 1240-1241AD Mongol destruction of Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Iziaslavl and Kolodyazhyn, regional population fell to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M in 1250AD (-31,9% from 1200AD), before recovering under King Daniel Romanovich (crowned 1253AD), Lev Danilovich and Yuri I Lvovich around the new royal capitals of *Kholm* and *Lviv* to 1,38M in 1300AD [11][12].

Background

Geographically, the region spans nine modern western and right-bank Ukrainian oblasts (~176.200 km^2) across the Upper and Middle Dniester, Western Bug, San, Styr, Horyn, Upper Pripyat, Upper Prut and Upper Tisza river basins. Historically, this territory formed the south-western march of unified Kievan Rus (981-1133AD) and later divided into the Rostislavichi Galician principalities, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities and the unified Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (1199-1341AD).

The Rostislavichi Galician principalities (49.600 km^2 across Lvivska, Ivano-Frankivska, Ternopilska and the San-Cherven strip) encompassed the Principality of Peremyshl (1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E), the Principality of Zvenyhorod (1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E), the Principality of Terebovlia (1133-1142AD, 49,3°N, 25,69°E) and the unified Principality of Halych (1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E), consolidated by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD) around the 200 ha urban complex of Halych (*Krylos*, 30k at 1200AD) [10][12][13]. To the north, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities (40.190 km^2 across Volynska, Rivnenska and the Left-Bank Western Bug) encompassed the Principality of Volhynia (1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E) centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha, 22k at 1200AD) and Daniel's royal capital at Kholm (*Chelm*, 8k in 1240AD and 12k in 1300AD), the Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E) across the Styr, Ikva and Horyn (*Pogoryrina*) basins (*Lutsk* 10k, *Peresopnytsia* 5k, *Dorogobuzh* 4,5k, *Kremenets* 4k, *Iziaslavl*) and the Principality of Belz (1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E; *Belz* 6k, *Busk* 4k) [2][3][14]. To the south and east, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, Transcarpathia and the southern frontier marches (86.410 km^2 across Khmelnytska, Vinnytska, Chernivetska and Zakarpatska) encompassed the Middle Dniester canyon of Ponizia (*Bakota* 26 ha, 5,5k; *Kamianets* 22 ha, 4k; *Ushitsa*, *Kalius*, *Kuchelmin*), the Western Bolokhov Land (*Medzhybizh* 4k, *Bozhsky*), Shipenitskaya Zemlya in Northern Bukovina (*Lenkivtsi* or *Chern* on the Prut 3,5k, *Khotyn*), Subcarpathian Rus (*Uzhhorod* or *Ungvar* 3,5k, *Mukachevo*) and dynastic links to the Pontic-Crimean outposts of Tmutarakan (988-1100sAD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*, 1204-1300AD) [15][16][17].

Results

Prehistoric and Iron Age Settlement (10000BC - 500AD)

Upper Palaeolithic, Neolithic and Trypillia-Cucuteni Eneolithic (10000BC - 1500BC)

Unlike the glaciated northern forest basins of European Russia, the deep limestone canyons of the Middle Dniester, Prut and upper Volhynian uplands functioned as one of Europe's main periglacial refugia throughout the terminal Pleistocene (10000BC) [18]. Multilayered open-air camp complexes at Molodova I and Molodova V, Korman IV, Babin I and Voronovitsa along the Dniester canyon, together with the Korolevo sequence on the Tisza in Transcarpathia and Kulychivka (at Kremenets) in Volhynia, preserve continuous Magdalenian and Epigravettian mammoth- and reindeer-hunter horizons supporting a 10000BC regional population of 16k (16.000, range 8k - 28k) [18].

During the Early Holocene (6500BC - 4500BC), indigenous Mesolithic fisher-foragers of the Bug-Dniester Culture (*Soroky*, *Bazkiv Ostriv*, *Pechera* and *Sokoltsi* on the Southern Bug) adopted early ceramics and domesticated plants through contact with Linearbandkeramik (LBK) farmers advancing along the Carpathian piedmont into the Upper Dniester and Western Bug loess terraces (*Nezvysko*, *Torskie*, *Zymne*, *Kotiv* and *Rivne*) [4]. By 5000BC, permanent LBK longhouse villages and Bug-Dniester riverine settlements supported 65k (65.000) inhabitants.

Between 4200BC and 3000BC, the Dniester-Prut-Southern Bug plateaus and southern Volhynian uplands formed the western heartland of the Trypillia-Cucuteni Culture (Stages BI-BII and CI-CII), with over 800 documented settlements (n=800) [4]. Along the Upper and Middle Dniester loess terraces, multiphase promontory settlements and ritual cave sites flourished at Bilche-Zolote (Verteba Cave, 2,5k), Koshylivtsi-Oboz (2,5k), Zalishchyky (2,2k), Nezvysko (1,8k), Horodnytsia (1,8k), Buchach (1,6k) and Polivanov Yar (1,5k) [4]. In the Volhynian-Horyn flint-mining and workshop zone, Late Trypillian (CI-CII) fortified promontory settlements at Bodaki on the Horyn (2k), Zymne, Khoriv and Lystvyn mined and exported Turonian dark flint blades across the Carpathian-Pontic region [4]. Further east along the Podolian and Southern Bug corridor, large concentric-plan settlements at Stina (3k), Nemyriv (2,2k) and Klishchiv (2k) linked the Dniester valley and the Bug-Dnieper mega-site zone.

At the 3500BC Eneolithic benchmark, the regional population reached 260k (260.000, range 180k - 360k). During the Early and Middle Bronze Age (2500BC - 1200BC), pastoral Corded Ware (*Pidkarpatska kultura shnurovoi keramiky*), Komariv (centred on *Komariv* near Halych, exploiting sub-Carpathian salt springs and Transylvanian bronze trade) and Noua communities expanded across the Carpathian piedmont and Volhynian forest-steppe, raising regional population to 310k (310.000) at 1500BC [10].

Scythian Hillforts and the Chernyakhov Horizon (500BC - 500AD)

In the Early Iron Age (700BC - 300BC), the Hallstatt-influenced Vysotska Culture (Lvivska and Ternopilska oblasts) and the Early Scythian West Podolian Group along the Middle Dniester and Southern Bug built large earthen-rampart hillforts [5]. The largest regional stronghold was the Nemyriv Hillfort (*Nemyrivske horodyshche*, 48,97°N, 28,84°E), enclosed by 9 m-high ramparts (5,5 km perimeter) encompassing 110 ha, with Milesian and Attic black-glazed pottery (sixth to fifth centuries BC) and an estimated population of 4,5k (4.500) [5]. Alongside sister hillforts at Severynivka (2,5k), Hryhorivka (2,2k), Chornoliska and Vysotske, South-Western Rus supported 490k (490.000) inhabitants at 500BC.

During the Roman Imperial period (100AD - 400AD), the Lipitsa (Dacian-Thracian salt-workers of the Upper Dniester), Przeworsk, Wielbark (along the Western Bug and Styr), Carpathian Tumuli and Zubrytska cultures merged in the third and fourth centuries AD into the agricultural expansion of the Chernyakhov Culture [6][7]. Excavations at Ripniv II, Lepesivka, Bovshiv, Demianiv, Cherneliv-Ruskyi,

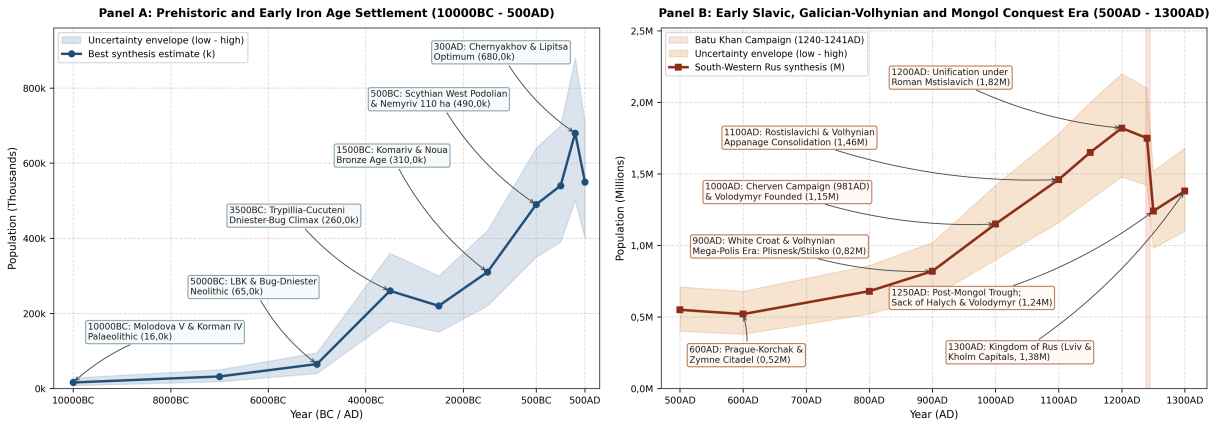


Figure 2. Population of South-Western Rus across Galicia, Volhynia and Ponizia from the Upper Palaeolithic to 1300AD (10000BC - 1300AD).

Bakota and Sokol record heavy iron-shod plough cultivation, rotary querns, glass-working kilns and Roman denarius hoards, raising the regional population to an antique peak of 680k (680.000) at 300AD [6].

Table 1. Prehistoric, antique and early Slavic population across the sub-regions of South-Western Rus (10000BC - 900AD).

Benchmark	Galicia Core (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Terebovlia)	Volhynia, Lutsk & Belz	Ponizia (Podolia) & Bolokhov West	Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total (Range)
10000BC	6k	4k	4k	2k	16k (8 - 28k)
5000BC	26k	18k	14k	7k	65k (40 - 95k)
3500BC	105k	65k	62k	28k	260k (180 - 360k)
1500BC	125k	85k	65k	35k	310k (220 - 420k)
500BC	195k	125k	120k	50k	490k (350 - 640k)
300AD	275k	180k	155k	70k	680k (500 - 880k)
600AD	215k	145k	105k	55k	520k (380 - 680k)
800AD	340k	215k	80k	45k	680k (520 - 860k)
900AD	415k	260k	95k	50k	820k (640 - 1,02M)

Early Slavic and Galician-Volhynian Era (600AD - 1300AD)

Prague-Korchak Strongholds and Tribal Centres (600AD - 980AD)

Following the post-Chernyakhov transition (fifth and sixth centuries AD), the Upper Dniester, Western Bug and Styr-Horyn basins became the core of the Early Slavic Prague-Korchak Culture (520k regional population at 600AD) [7][19]. At Zymne on the Luha River near Volodymyr (50,8°N, 24,33°E), V. V. Aulikh excavated a sixth- to seventh-century AD timber-palisaded citadel (1,5k inhabitants) yielding non-ferrous jewellery moulds, iron weapons, silvered belt mounts and Byzantine coins of Justinian I and Justin II (527-578AD), destroyed during the Avar wars against the *Duliby* [19]. Contemporaneous early Slavic settlements stood at Ripniv, Bovshiv, Zelene, Krylos and Rashkiv [7].

During the Luka-Raikovetska tribal era (800AD 680k; 900AD 820k), the White Croats, Volhynians, Buzhany and Tivertsi built large multi-part hillforts (*gorodishcha*): Plisnesk (160 ha across seven defensive rampart lines, 6k in 900AD) [20], Stilsko (200 ha enclosure on the Kolodnytsia with 10 km of ramparts, 7k in 900AD), Old Halych (*Krylos*, 4,5k in 900AD), Revne (2,5k), Volyn (*Grudek*, 3,5k), Cherven (3k), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 2,5k) and Peremyshl (3,5k) [2][10][16]. After Grand Prince Vladimir the Great's 981AD Cherven campaign, his 992AD Croat campaign and the foundation of Volodymyr (988AD), regional population reached 1,15M (1,15M) at 1000AD [2].

Devolved Principalities (1084AD - 1200AD)

Between 1084AD (when the Rostislavichi brothers established separate rule in Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod and Terebovlia, ratified at the 1097AD Council of Liubech) and 1199AD (when Roman Mstislavich united Galicia and Volhynia), South-Western Rus developed the densest network of fortified towns in Kievan Rus, with 350 excavated *gorodishcha* (n=350) catalogued by A. V. Kuza and B. P. Tomenchuk: 92 in Halych and Terebovlia, 64 in Peremyshl and Zvenyhorod, 78 in Volhynia and Belz, 68 in Lutsk and Pogoryrina and 48 in Ponizia and Bukovina [9][10][21].

In the Galician lands, the Principality of Halych (1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E) was unified by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD). Its capital at Halych (*Krylos*) encompassed a 200 ha settlement cluster along the Lukva and Dniester featuring the white-stone Dormition Cathedral (1157AD) and St. Panteleimon Church, housing 30k (30.000) inhabitants at 1200AD [10][12][13], supported by the sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres of Kolomyia (3,5k), Zudechev (Zhydachiv, 3k), Sudova Vyshnia (2,5k), Drohobych (2,2k), Dolyna (2k) and the rock fortress of Tustan (1,2k). The Principality of Peremyshl (1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E) was centred on Peremyshl (*Przemysl*, 38 ha *detinets* with a stone rotunda, *palatium* and *posad*, 9k at 1200AD), alongside Yaroslav (3,5k), Sanok (2,5k) and Sambir (2,2k) [12]. The Principality of Zvenyhorod (1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E) was centred on Zvenyhorod (45 ha citadel and waterlogged *posad* yielding Birch-Bark Letters Nos. 1-3, 10k at 1200AD) and Plisnesk (4,5k in 1200AD), and after c. 1256AD was superseded by Lviv (12k by 1300AD) [12][20]. The Principality of Terebovlia (1133-1142AD, 49,3°N, 25,69°E) was centred on Terebovlia (30 ha, 6,5k at 1200AD), Vasyliv on the Dniester (35 ha with a white-stone church, 5k at 1200AD), Mykulyntsi (2,2k), Zbarazh (2k) and Onut (1,8k) [1][16].

In the Volhynian and southern borderlands, the Principality of Volhynia (1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E) was centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha rampart and *posad* complex with the 1160AD Mstislav Dormition Cathedral, 22k at 1200AD), Kholm (*Chelm*, Daniel's royal capital from c. 1237AD, 36 ha, 8k at 1240AD and 12k at 1300AD), Cherven (3,5k), Ugrovesk (2,8k), Liuboml (2,5k), Vsevolozh (2,2k), Suteisk (2k) and Volyn (*Grudek*, 1,8k) [2][22]. The Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E) was centred on Lutsk (*Luchsk*, 40 ha, 10k at 1200AD), Peresopnytsia (24 ha, 5k), Dorogobuzh-on-Horyn (22 ha, 4,5k), Kremenets (20 ha, 4k), Iziaslavl (2,8k in 1200AD; burned 1241AD layer excavated by M. K. Karger), Dubno (2,8k), Shumsk (2,8k), Ostroh (2,5k), Chortoryisk (2,2k), Danyliv (2k), Stepan (2k) and Peremyl (2k) [14][23]. The Principality of Belz (1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E) was centred on Belz (28 ha, 6k at 1200AD), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 22 ha, 4k) and Sokal (1,8k) [12]. Finally, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya and Transcarpathia were centred on Bakota (26 ha, 5,5k), Kamianets (22 ha, 4k), Medzhybizh (4k), Bozhsky (3,5k), Lenkivtsi (*Chern*) on the Prut (3,5k), Uzhhorod (*Ungvar*, 3,5k), Ushitsa (3k), Khotyn (3k), Kalius (2,5k), Mukachevo (2,5k) and Kuchelmin (2k), alongside the Pontic outposts of Tmutarakan (8k in 1050-1100AD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*, 6,5k in 1250-1300AD) [15][16].

Mongol Invasion and the Kingdom of Rus (1240AD - 1300AD)

On the eve of Batu Khan's western campaign (1240AD), the unified Romanovichi realm supported 1,75M (1,75M) inhabitants, down slightly from the 1,82M 1200AD unification peak following the 1205-1238AD boyar and Hungarian wars of succession. During the winter campaign of December 1240AD - March 1241AD, Mongol armies stormed and burned Iziaslavl, Kolodyazhyn, Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Peresopnytsia and Terebovlia, reducing the regional population to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M (1,24M) in 1250AD (-31,9% below 1200AD) [11][23]. Because the cliff fortresses of Kremenets and Danyliv, the new royal capital at Kholm, Bakota in Ponizia and the Carpathian mountain valleys survived intact, King Daniel Romanovich (crowned *Rex Russiae* at Dorohychyn in 1253AD), Vasilko Romanovich, Lev Danilovich (who made Lviv the main capital in 1272AD) and Yuri I Lvovich led a demographic and urban recovery across the Kingdom of Rus, reaching 1,38M (1,38M) by 1300AD [1][12][22].

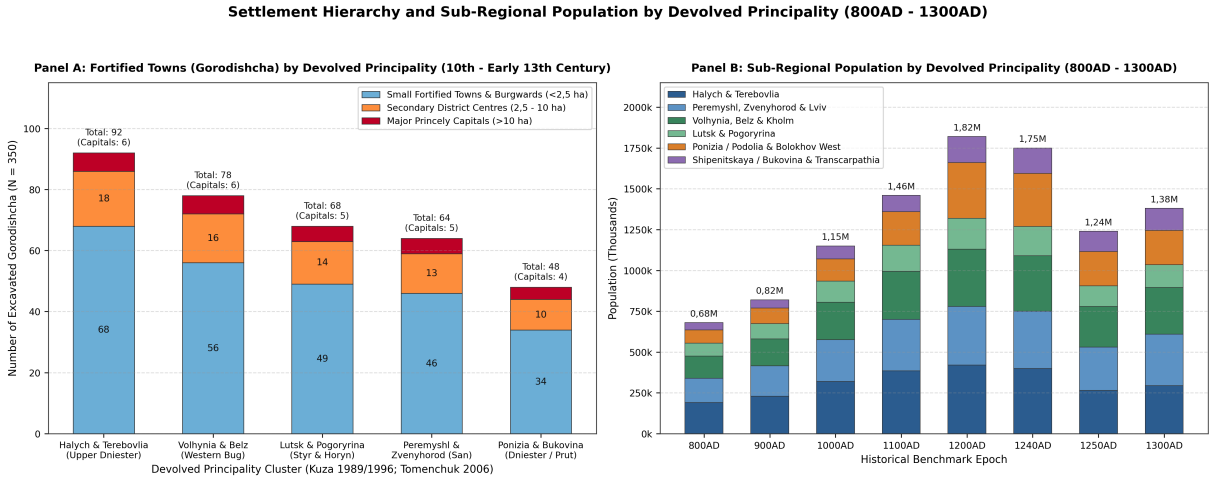


Figure 3. Settlement hierarchy and sub-regional population distribution by principality in South-Western Rus (800AD - 1300AD).

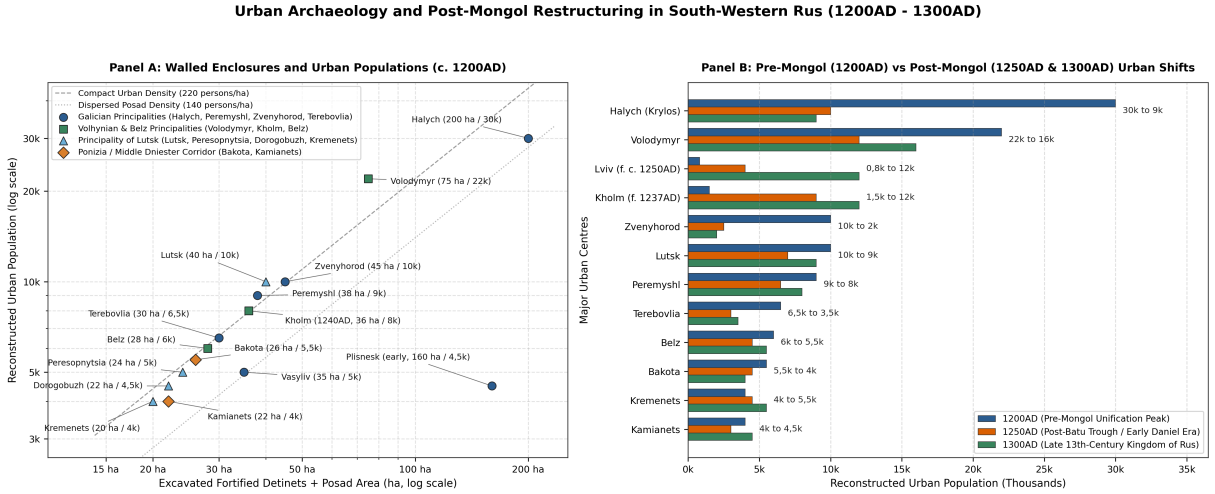


Figure 4. Urban archaeological footprint and post-Mongol population changes across South-Western Rus (1200AD - 1300AD).

Table 2. Medieval sub-regional population breakdown by principality cluster in South-Western Rus (1000AD - 1300AD).

Benchmark	Halych & Terebovlia	Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Lviv	Volhynia, Belz & Kholm	Principality of Lutsk	Ponizia, Bolokhov, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total
1000AD	320k	255k	230k	130k	215k	1,15M (1,15M)
1100AD	385k	315k	295k	160k	305k	1,46M (1,46M)
1150AD	405k	340k	325k	175k	405k	1,65M (1,65M)

Cross-Regional Comparison (1000AD - 1300AD)

To maintain consistency across the historical dataset, Table 3 compares South-Western Rus (Galicia and Volhynia) with the northern and eastern Rus principalities documented in the companion European Russia regional review [3][8][21].

Table 3. Cross-regional population comparison between South-Western Rus and the northern and eastern Rus principalities (1000AD - 1300AD).

Polity/Regional Unit	1000AD Pop.	1100AD Pop.	1200AD Apogee	1250AD Trough	1300AD Pop.
Galician Principalities (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia)	575k	700k	780k	530k	610k
Volhynian Principalities (Volodymyr, Kholm, Lutsk, Belz)	360k	455k	540k	375k	425k
Ponizia (Podolia), Bolokhov West, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	215k	305k	500k	335k	345k
Galicia and Volhynia Subtotal	1,15M	1,46M	1,82M	1,24M	1,38M
cf. Vladimir-Suzdal/Rostov (European Russia)	340k	510k	780k	520k	640k
cf. Novgorod & Pskov Republics (European Russia)	290k	380k	480k	460k	510k
cf. Principality of Smolensk (European Russia)	210k	275k	340k	290k	310k
cf. Total European Russia Benchmark	2,15M	2,9M	3,85M	2,8M	3,1M

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